Rummikub

Rummikub is a tile-based strategy game where the goal is to be the first player to empty your rack by forming valid groups and runs.

Game Setup

- **The Tiles**: The game uses 106 tiles, including numbers 1–13 in four colors (black, red, blue, yellow) and 2 jokers.
- **The Deal**: Each player draws 14 tiles and places them on their rack. The remaining tiles form the pool.
- **Going First**: Each player draws one tile; the highest number goes first. Play then moves clockwise.

Valid Sets

- **Groups**: Three or four identical numbers in different colors (e.g., a red 7, a blue 7, and a black 7). No two tiles in a group can be the same color.
- **Runs**: Three or more consecutive numbers of the same color (e.g., a blue 4, 5, and 6). The number 1 is always low and cannot follow 13.

The Initial Meld (30-Point Rule)

- Your very first play onto the table must consist of sets from your rack that total **at least 30 points**.
- You cannot use tiles already on the table to help reach this 30-point minimum.
- If you cannot make a 30-point meld on your turn, you must draw one tile from the pool, and your turn ends.

Turn Rules & Table Manipulation

- **Building on Sets**: After your initial meld, you can add tiles from your rack to existing sets on the table, split runs, or rearrange tiles to form new combinations.
- **Valid Board State**: Every set on the table must be valid (at least 3 tiles) when your turn ends. If an illegal move is made, tiles must go back and you take a penalty.

- **Drawing**: If you cannot play or choose not to play a tile from your rack, you must draw one tile from the pool. You cannot immediately play a tile you just drew.
- **Time Limits**: Online or official versions typically enforce a strict timer (usually 1 to 2 minutes per turn).

Jokers

- **Wildcard**: A joker can stand in for any number or color in a set.
- **Retrieval**: You can replace a joker on the board with the exact tile it represents from your rack, but the retrieved joker must be used immediately in a new set on the same turn.

Winning & Scoring

- **Winning**: The first player to empty their rack calls **"Rummikub!"** to win the round.
- **Scoring**: The winner receives a positive score equal to the sum of all remaining point values on opponents' racks. Losers receive negative points, and holding an unplayed joker at the end incurs a heavy 30-point penalty. You can check out the official platform on the Rummikub Website for digital play options and updates.